

Continuous Improvement & Non-Conformance Policy

RELEVANT STANDARD(S):

Standards for Registered Training Organisations (RTOs) 2025,	<i>including:</i> • Outcome Standard 4.4 – Systematic monitoring, evaluation and continuous improvement • Outcome Standard 4.1 – Leadership, accountability and governance • Outcome Standard 4.3 – Risk identification and management • Outcome Standard 1.5 – Validation of assessment • Outcome Standard 1.1 & 1.2 – Quality training and assessment outcomes
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Purpose

SNS College of Western Australia Pty Ltd is committed to a **systematic, evidence-based approach to continuous improvement** that supports high-quality training and assessment outcomes, learner protection, and ongoing compliance with the Standards for RTOs 2025.

This policy establishes the **governance framework** through which SNS College:

- monitors performance and compliance;
- evaluates the effectiveness of systems, training and assessment practices; and
- implements corrective and improvement actions based on risk, evidence, and outcomes.

SCOPE

This policy applies to:

- all training and assessment products and services;
- all RTO systems, policies, procedures and resources; and
- all staff, contractors, trainers, assessors and governance personnel.

POLICY PRINCIPLES, COMMITMENTS AND RESPONSIBILITIES

This table intentionally mirrors the Validation Policy structure for consistency and audit traceability.

Policy Principle	SNS Commitment	Key Responsibilities	Supporting Documents / Systems
Systematic quality assurance	Continuous improvement is embedded, planned and ongoing across all RTO operations	CEO ensures CI systems are implemented and resourced	CI Policy; CI Procedure; Governance Framework
Risk-based prioritisation	Improvement actions are prioritised based on learner risk, compliance impact and delivery risk	Compliance Manager maintains CI priorities and risk ratings	CI Register; RTO Risk Register
Evidence-based decision-making	Decisions are informed by data, feedback, validation outcomes and audits	Compliance Manager analyses CI data; Managers provide evidence	Validation Reports; Audit Reports; Feedback Data
Integrated monitoring	CI integrates validation, audits, complaints, feedback and industry engagement	Compliance Manager coordinates monitoring inputs	Validation Schedule; Audit Schedule; IE Register
Accountability and ownership	CI actions are assigned, tracked and closed with accountability	Responsible managers implement and report on actions	CI Register; Action Plans
Continuous improvement culture	Staff are encouraged and supported to identify improvement opportunities	All staff contribute to CI identification	Opportunity for Improvement Form
Governance oversight	CI outcomes inform leadership decision-making and strategic planning	CEO and senior management review CI outcomes	Management Review Records; Governance Minutes

Governance and Accountability

SNS College's governance framework ensures that governing persons maintain oversight of compliance, quality, risk, and continuous improvement outcomes.

Governance responsibilities include:

- oversight of regulatory compliance and organisational risk;
- review of continuous improvement trends, risk ratings, and unresolved issues;
- approval of significant corrective actions and system changes; and
- ensuring sufficient resources are allocated to maintain compliance and training quality.

Governance oversight is exercised through scheduled management review meetings, compliance reporting, and documented decision-making.

CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT FRAMEWORK

SNS College applies a **continuous improvement cycle** that includes:

- identification of improvement opportunities;
- analysis and prioritisation based on risk;
- implementation of corrective or improvement actions;
- monitoring of effectiveness; and
- formal closure and review.

Continuous improvement activities may be **planned or reactive** and occur as required.

Risk Management Integration

SNS College identifies, assesses, manages and reviews risks to learners, staff and the organisation as part of its continuous improvement system.

Risks may be identified through audits, validation, feedback, incidents, complaints, operational reviews or regulatory change. Identified risks are recorded in the RTO Risk Register and reviewed for effectiveness of controls.

Where risk controls are ineffective or improvement is required, actions are recorded and tracked through the Continuous Improvement Register.

SOURCES OF CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT DATA

Continuous improvement opportunities may arise from, but are not limited to:

- internal and external audits;
- assessment validation outcomes;
- learner, employer and trainer feedback;
- complaints and appeals;
- industry engagement activities;
- compliance monitoring;
- risk assessments; and
- staff-identified improvement opportunities.

RECORDING AND MANAGEMENT OF CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

All identified improvement opportunities are:

- documented in the **Continuous Improvement (CI) Register**;
- assigned a risk rating and priority;
- allocated to a responsible person; and
- monitored until implemented and formally closed.

CI actions and outcomes are reviewed at **scheduled compliance and governance meetings**.

INTERNAL AND EXTERNAL AUDITS

SNS College conducts **planned internal audits** to assess compliance and system effectiveness in line with the Internal Audit Procedure.

Audit outcomes:

- are documented in audit reports;
- generate CI actions where required; and
- feed directly into the CI Register.

SNS College cooperates fully with all **external audits and regulatory monitoring activities**.

FEEDBACK AND STAKEHOLDER INPUT

SNS College systematically collects and analyses feedback from:

- learners and employers;
- trainers and assessors;
- industry representatives;
- staff; and
- regulators (where applicable).

Feedback mechanisms include surveys, reports, meetings, validation activities, and formal complaints or appeals.

COMPLAINTS, APPEALS AND CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

Where a complaint or appeal identifies a system, process or resource issue:

- corrective action is implemented immediately where required; and
- the outcome is recorded as a CI action.

(Refer to Complaints and Appeals Policy and Procedure.)

POLICY REVIEW

This policy is reviewed:

- **at least annually**, and
- following regulatory, organisational or risk-based changes.

Approved amendments are recorded in the CI Register and version control table.

Version Control

Version Control Table					
Date	Summary of Modifications	Modified by	Version	Date of Implementation	Next Review Date
26/01/2026	Reconstructed Continuous Improvement & Non-Conformance Policy and Procedure to establish a single, integrated CINC framework. Incorporated validation outcomes, industry engagement, transition reviews, complaints and appeals, audits, and legislative updates into one system with a single online submission form and central CI Register. Aligned to Standards for RTOs 2025.	SNS	1.0	26/01/2026	26/01/2027

RTO INFORMATION

Document Name	SNS-POL-CINC Policy V2.0
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